TOPIC 1 · MICROSOFT 365 COPILOT FUNDAMENTALS
LAB 1 THEME · EXCEL TO WORD

Lab 1 — Prepare HR Cases and Draft the HR Service Brief

Maps to	LO1: predict and mitigate integration challenges through verified cross-app grounding and handoffs.
Duration	30 minutes
Tools	Microsoft 365 Copilot · Excel · Word · PowerPoint · Outlook · OneDrive
Mock data	data/Lumina_HR_Cases.xlsx
Course	Enhance Work Productivity with Microsoft 365 Copilot (TGS-2024043856) · v9.3
Prompts	https://tertiarycourses.github.io/TGS-2024043856-Enhance-Work-Productivity-with-Microsoft-365-Copilot/prompts/#lab-1

Goal

You are Lumina Living's HR operations executive. A Q3 export contains repeated IDs and inconsistent category labels. You will clean a copy in Excel, reconcile its controls, and use the verified result to draft a Word HR service brief. The same department, status and assignment definitions underpin every later report.

What You Will Do

You are Lumina Living's HR operations executive. A Q3 export contains repeated IDs and inconsistent category labels. You will clean a copy in Excel, reconcile its controls, and use the verified result to draft a Word HR service brief. The same department, status and assignment definitions underpin every later report.

What You Will Build

Lumina_Clean_HR_Cases.xlsx and Lumina_HR_Service_Brief.docx, with reconciled counts, reporting scope and a source register.

Prerequisites

- Microsoft 365 account with Copilot available in Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Outlook. Availability depends on the assigned licence and tenant settings; confirm access with the trainer before class.
- Desktop Excel on Windows or Mac is recommended; save working copies to your assigned OneDrive course folder with AutoSave on. Do not overwrite the supplied input.
- Download this whole lab folder. All files are synthetic; Lumina-HR-v9 is your own learner output folder.

Data note

Lumina Living Pte Ltd and all of its employees, HR cases and HR policies are fictional. Use the verified 120-case baseline and fixed reporting date 30 September 2026. Current case owners are evidence; proposals are not approved. The HR agent answers from approved knowledge only and never approves requests, sends messages or reveals another employee's data.

Steps

Step 1. Copy data/Lumina_HR_Cases.xlsx to your OneDrive Lumina-HR-v9 folder as Lumina_Clean_HR_Cases.xlsx. Open it in Excel, set Formulas > Calculation Options > Automatic, and read About_This_Data and Control. The workbook is the deliberately dirty 122-row input; the supplied CSV is a clean reference and must not replace the cleaning exercise. Open Copilot from Home > Copilot.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
EXCEL - CHAT ONLY:
Read About_This_Data and Control for Lumina Living. Explain what one employee HR case
represents, the reporting date, the five request types and how current owners differ from
proposed owners. Do not edit or infer employee impacts.
```

Step 2. Use Chat only to inspect the named table before making changes. Record row count and the two exact repeated IDs. A Case_ID is the row grain; do not count repeated export records twice.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
EXCEL - CHAT ONLY:
Inspect tblHRCases. Report row count, duplicate Case_ID values, category spelling variants and
missing Assigned_To. Do not edit. Treat 2026-09-30 as the fixed reporting date.
```

Step 3. Choose Plan if available. Read the proposed cleaning plan before using Allow editing. The duplicates are exact repeated export records: keep one per ID. Trim and standardise category labels to Leave Request, Training Request, Onboarding, Payroll Query, Benefits Claim; preserve missing owners and all unique source values. Save a copy of the raw sheet before the change.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
EXCEL - PLAN:
Plan to retain an untouched Raw_Export copy, remove only exact duplicate records by Case_ID,
and standardise category spelling in tblHRCases. Keep dates, statuses and assignments. Ask if
two records with one ID differ.

EXCEL - ALLOW EDITING:
Apply the reviewed plan. Keep one identical record per repeated ID. Do not guess missing
owners. Reconcile the cleaned table against Control.
```

Step 4. Add a Checks sheet or use the supplied one. Ask for formulas, then inspect the table and formulas yourself. Overdue excludes Closed and Cancelled and uses strictly earlier than the fixed date, so a due-today case is not overdue. Copy verified values to data/templates/Evidence_Register.csv.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
EXCEL - ALLOW EDITING:
In Checks calculate total rows, closed, cancelled, backlog, overdue backlog, unassigned
backlog and total Cost_SGD for tblHRCases. Use Control!B2 as reporting date. Define backlog as
Status neither Closed nor Cancelled. Add the identity total = closed + cancelled + backlog. Do
not change source data.
```

Step 5. Open data/templates/Lumina_HR_Service_Brief_Template.docx in Word and save as Lumina_HR_Service_Brief.docx in OneDrive. In Copilot select the verified source file using Reference a file or /. If Word cannot use the workbook, copy your verified evidence table plus data/Lumina_HR_Context.txt into the document and select that text; do not imply Word reads the Excel chat.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
WORD COPILOT:
Draft a one-page Lumina HR service brief from the verified evidence supplied here. Include
reporting scope/date, backlog and overdue findings, current assignment issues, proposed next
actions and open questions. Keep observed facts separate from proposals. Preserve numbers and
definitions. Use UNKNOWN for causes, approvals or capacity decisions not evidenced.
```

Step 6. Compare every number and HR-case ID in the Word brief to Checks and the evidence register. Add the OneDrive source link and all-filters scope. Log the Word prompt manually in Excel Prompt_Log because Excel cannot access the Word conversation. Save the cleaned workbook and brief for Lab 2.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
WORD COPILOT:
Audit this Lumina Living HR service brief against the verified evidence table I supply. Return
a discrepancy list for counts, cost, reporting scope, overdue definition and assignment
claims. Identify missing source links as UNKNOWN. Do not change facts or approve work.
```

Sample Prompts

Use the app labelled for each prompt (or adapt it). Name the table and columns, state the output, and always verify the result. Use the linked prompts web page for one-click Copy buttons.

Copy-ready prompts: https://tertiarycourses.github.io/TGS-2024043856-Enhance-Work-Productivity-with-Microsoft-365-Copilot/prompts/#lab-1

#	Purpose	Prompt
1	Inspect	Using Lumina_HR_Cases.xlsx, confirm 120 unique Case_ID values, preserve Current_Assignee, and report data-quality exceptions at 30 September 2026.
2	Brief	Draft the Lumina HR Service Brief from the verified 120-row snapshot; cite backlog 60 and overdue 50 and label missing causes UNKNOWN.

Test It

Check	Expected result
Clean table	120 unique Case_ID rows; five canonical request types.
Portfolio identity	120 = 48 Closed + 12 Cancelled + 60 backlog.
Evidence handoff	Overdue 50; unassigned backlog 6; total cost S$35,827.50. Word agrees with Excel.
No guessed owner	Blank assignments remain blank; proposals labelled unapproved.

Checkpoint

If you fell behind, use data/checkpoints/Lumina_Verified_Checkpoint.xlsx and data/checkpoints/Lumina_Verified_Snapshot.docx. Record checkpoint used in Prompt_Log; then perform this lab, rather than claiming the checkpoint as your output.

Troubleshooting

If this happens	Fix
Copilot cannot find the source	Use the app file picker to select the actual OneDrive file. A typed local path or a different app chat is not shared context. If needed copy only the verified snapshot into the current app.
A total disagrees with Control	Clear dashboard filters to All, check table extent and duplicate IDs, recalculate, then compare definitions and reporting date. Reconcile before continuing.
The named feature is missing	Confirm the correct assigned account, English display language and app version. Use the stated manual practice route; record feature unavailable. This is not evidence that a native skill ran.

Challenge

Repeat the task for one different department and explain how the filter scope changes the result. Keep the original verified output.

Reflection

Which evidence proves the output is correct, and which decision still needs a person?